

CCAvenue.com

CC Avenue is a trusted Indian payment gateway, and boasts of clients such as C-DAC, TATA, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Mahindra and Mahindra, LG Electronics India, Reliance's Paradox Studios, and yes, even Digit. The fact that we use it should suffice as an explanation as to why we recommend it.

CCAvenue has two basic options for a payment gateway solution:

The Premium Scheme: This involves a one-time setup charge of Rs 25,000, and a software maintenance cost of Rs 2,400 per annum. They levy a charge of five per cent per transaction under this scheme, so for every Rs 1,000 that you sell online, Rs 50 goes to CCAvenue. You will have to price your products accordingly and cover this deficit of five per cent.



The main CCAvenue control panel screen

The Economy Scheme: For smaller businesses just starting up an online shop, this is perhaps the wiser option. There is the Rs 7,500 one-time setup fee, and a software maintenance charge of Rs 1,200 per annum. In this scheme, the per transaction charge is seven per cent.

You can always upgrade to the premium scheme later, by paying the difference in the setup fees. Also, you can do that only if you receive an overwhelming response to your online shop and end up paying a little too much to CCAvenue at the extra two per cent per transaction!

Setting It Up

In order to set up your payment gateway, all you need to do is log on to www.ccavenue.com and click on the 'Sign Up' link. Fill in all the details correctly, and you will be asked to pay for your gateway plan. You can pay by credit card, Net Banking, demand draft, or even by cheque.

Once you've paid, you will need to download a copy of the CCAvenue Client Agreement, downloadable from http://snipurl.com/digit_cca1, or

You can always upgrade to the premium scheme later, by paying the difference in the setup fees



View details of all transactions over the past months



From the CCAvenue control panel you can get quick statistics for the past week, month, or year as well

viewable at http://snipurl.com/digit_cca2. You will need to print this on a Rs 100 stamp paper, and have it filled in, signed and stamped by an authorised signatory for your company, and then snail-mailed to CCAvenue.

Once you have been approved, your account will go online and you will receive instructions on how to go about integrating your site with CCAvenue in order to offer your visitors the ability to purchase merchandise.

Using your Account

CCAvenue charges your clients for you, and then puts each order into an accounting module in your account with CCAvenue. You have to log in frequently to your CCAvenue account and update the status of each order to 'Shipped' or 'Executed'. Only then is the payment delivered to your account. Failure to update the status of a pending transaction for 12 days results in the money being credited back to the customer, and you lose a perfectly good order.

Apart from the little coding required to integrate the module that CCAvenue provides you with, everything else should be a breeze. Even the module integration should be easy for any competent Webmaster or systems administrator. CCAvenue will provide you with modules based on ASP, PHP, JAVA and .NET, so 99 per cent of Web sites should have no problems with the integration.

The setup procedure is pretty much the same for any payment gateway provider that you choose, and the control panels will be similar. Within a matter of three or four days after applying for a payment gateway, you should be able to begin integrating your site with it. Do write in to us and let us know if this article helped your company's business grow. ■

robert_smith@thinkdigit.com

Choosing The Right Payment Options

Choosing the right payment options can mean as much as 50 per cent more online business for you. Using your payment gateway, you can also choose to add Net Banking and debit cards as options for payment. You should also design your shopping cart in such a way that the Cheque, Demand Drafts and Cash On Delivery payment options are also included, which should then point to another page within your Web site itself. Be sure to mention all important details, such as the name the cheque should be made out to, in crisp bold lettering—one spelling mistake could cause a lot of unnecessary headaches.

Also make sure you have trustworthy resources and manpower to execute the Cash on Delivery payment option, else it would be wise to steer clear of offering it.